

Organizer Trial Guide

A direct, persona-based walkthrough for event organizers evaluating Conference Ops without needing engineering support.

DOCUMENT	PRODUCT	USE
Organizer guide	Conference Ops 0.3.0	Follow in order



OPEN THE CURRENT DEPLOYED PILOT

<https://conference-ops-pilot-app.techfren.workers.dev>

Create and verify your own account. Deployment is a separate release step; confirm the visible version before testing 0.3.0.

01 / BEFORE YOU START

Use a safe, realistic trial setup

Your account

Open the pilot, create and verify your own account, then create an event. Do not ask for or use the Apricot operator password. Use Forgot password only for your own approved inbox.

Persona	Recommended tester	Why
Organizer	You, with your own work email	Owns setup, routing, decisions, schedule, publication, and monitoring.
Applicant	A separate email/account	Proves drafts, submission, revision, confirmation, and status projection.
Reviewer	A different person/account	Self-review is blocked and track coverage is explicit.
Speaker	Accepted participant email/account	Proves claim, tasks, files, profile, comments, and resources.
Public attendee	Signed-out/private window	Proves only published allowlisted data is visible.

Safety checklist

- Use synthetic or representative event, profile, travel, and file data.
- Send email/calendar only to approved test recipients.
- Never paste passwords, reset/invitation links, Airtable tokens, webhook secrets, or provisioning files into feedback.
- Keep the pilot invitation to named testers; broad anonymous launch needs abuse and file-scanning controls.

02 / LAUNCH AND BRAND

Start from a useful structure, then make it yours

Step	Do this	Check this
1	Open the pilot, sign up, and complete email verification.	You reach the private event/workspace flow.
2	Choose Starter blueprint, CSV structure, or Airtable preparation. Preview the selected rooms, tracks, and workflows.	Nothing is created until confirmation; invalid CSV rows are blocked.
3	Choose Conference, Workshop, Internal summit, or Technical multi-track; enter event identity, timezone, dates, close, venue, site, and accent.	CFP close is before event start; Create is blocked if not.
4	Create, open Event details, and reload. Then open Program setup > Brand & previews.	Values persist; apply a JPEG/PNG/WebP logo and semantic accent.
5	Use Preview as... for applicant, reviewer, speaker, and public, then open Guided tour.	Preview is read-only; tour checks can reset without deleting data.
6	Open Control Room and Rooms/Tracks.	Now/Next/Proof, activity timeline, intended venue lanes, forms, tasks, messages, and reminders are present.

Fresh-event defaults

The selected blueprint or import creates an operable starting plan. Review every generated lane and workflow before inviting participants; templates are examples, not assumptions about your real event. Airtable preparation never requests a token in the browser or changes authority.

03 / BUILD THE CFP

Create, version, publish, and share the right form

In CFP builder

- Create or select a CFP. Use separate forms when different programs need independent questions, deadlines, or links.
- Edit welcome, proposal, participant, and confirmation copy.
- Configure participant minimum/maximum, submission limits, close time, redirect, confirmation, and long-text budget.
- Add and reorder text, long text, email, URL, select, multiselect, checkbox, or information fields.
- Keep a required track question. Use Dropdown for one track or Multi-select for one or more.
- Test one equals/contains visibility condition. Required validation applies only when the field is visible.
- Preview, save draft, reload, publish, and copy that form's public link. Do not reuse a different form's URL.

Control	Expected behavior
Create/clone/switch/close	Each CFP has its own versions and public link.
Save draft	New private version with concurrency protection.
Publish	Makes that version immutable and available publicly.
Pinned draft	An applicant keeps the form version they started with.
Public file question	Blocked; request files later as private speaker tasks.

Use explicit coverage and a distinct reviewer

Step	Organizer/reviewer action	Expected result
1	Map every track to one or more reviewer groups/reviewers.	No uncovered track; invitation alone grants no track access.
2	Create an independent review round with open/due dates, anonymization, and typed weighted criteria.	The round has its own plan, dates, and visibility contract.
3	Build the round's reviewer pool and per-reviewer cap, then generate exact assignments.	Only eligible work is assigned; caps and self-review exclusion hold.
4	Applicant submits one or more tracks; reviewer accepts or recuses with a reason.	Coverage follows selected tracks and recusals return work safely.
5	Reviewer scores, saves/reloads a draft, chooses Approve/Maybe/Deny, and submits.	Submitted evidence is immutable and server-computed totals are read-only.
6	Organizer checks progress, sends a controlled reminder, sorts aggregate results, and exports CSV.	Counts agree and exported cells are formula-safe.
7	Inspect bounded AI triage, override it if needed, then request changes or stage/finalize a decision.	Human action stays authoritative and is audited.

Revision behavior

Before the pinned CFP closes, an applicant can edit a non-final proposal or respond to an organizer change request. Accepted, rejected, and session-backed proposals remain locked. Each reopened revision receives fresh review work while submitted review evidence remains historical and organizer-visible.

05 / ACCEPT AND ONBOARD

Make the automatic handoff visible

Final acceptance is one guarded workflow. It creates the linked unscheduled session, activates eligible speaker access, creates every configured onboarding task, records audit evidence, and persists the configured decision email before delivery.

Speaker task	How to verify
Hotel stay	Complete the requirement form; organizer confirms the private travel response.
Flight reimbursement	Complete the reimbursement form; organizer confirms the private response.
Talk description	Update/finalize session-facing copy through the requested task.
Bio/photo	Complete profile and a representative headshot; only an organizer can publish it.
Slides/documents	Upload, replace, download current and prior versions, and add a task comment.
Calendar	Complete acknowledgement or receive a controlled RFC 5545 REQUEST invite.
External action	Open the organizer's HTTPS link, return, and mark the manual evidence appropriately.
Announcements/invites	Use optional manual/external tasks for announcing participation and inviting colleagues.

Private evidence

Speaker files and comments are task-scoped, and organizer travel details never appear in the speaker projection. Raw file bytes stay in private R2; only safe metadata may appear in Airtable. Use non-sensitive trial files because malware scanning is not yet a broad-launch control.

Organizer content check

- Edit the speaker/session content, inspect attributed revision history, restore one revision, and explicitly approve the final public content.

06 / SCHEDULE AND PUBLISH

Place the program, prove conflicts, then go public

Step	Action	Check
1	Create/edit rooms and tracks. Keep capacity, color, and names realistic.	Used rooms/tracks cannot be deleted silently.
2	Open Schedule and switch List, Day/Rooms, Week, and Conflicts.	View/filter/day state persists in the URL.
3	Choose Draft my schedule, inspect safe placements, apply once, undo the draft, then place by drag/drop/manual control.	Only conflict-free candidates are placed; undo returns the applied set to Ready to place.
4	Create a deliberate collision.	Conflict appears; choose another slot or give a durable override reason.
5	Reschedule and reload.	All views agree; calendar sequence increments for material invite changes.
6	Approve session content, complete readiness, and publish agenda.	Only approved eligible scheduled sessions become public.
7	Signed out, test Sessions, Speakers, Agenda, Itinerary, and Gallery plus details, filters, favorites, ICS, iframe/share, and feeds.	Only approved published allowlisted data appears.

Publication rule

New scheduled sessions remain private until content approval and Publish. A later content edit fails closed until re-approved; a material placement/content update advances the calendar sequence.

07 / COMMUNICATE AND SHARE

Use messages, resources, history, calendar, and exports

Capability	Organizer action	Proof
Templates	Edit submission, acceptance, rejection, reminder, and calendar copy; choose a sample speaker to resolve merge fields.	Save/reload shows event-scoped content and a personalized subject/body preview.
Test send	Confirm the displayed organizer recipient, then choose Send test to me.	The subject begins [TEST], never targets the sample speaker, and appears in delivery history.
Reminder rules	Tune draft and overdue-task timing; enable only for the test window.	Cron creates durable intents without duplicate send keys.
Manual message	Preview recipients, choose a small approved set, and queue once.	Delivery history shows sanitized kind/status/recipient evidence.
Calendar	Queue a REQUEST for scheduled/public eligible recipients.	Stable UID, sequence, room/time and attachment contract.
Resources	Create a plain-text guide, optional HTTPS reference, and publish.	Appears in participant portal and public resource index.
Exports	Download speakers.csv, sessions.csv, program.json, and the latest authorized speaker-file ZIP.	Protected filters apply; spreadsheet formula prefixes are neutralized; ZIP paths group current files by session.
Copilot	Ask what needs attention; open Preview action; inspect impact, reversibility, and human gate; then continue.	Changes now reads None; no mutation, send, publish, authority change, or decision occurs in preview.
Airtable proof	Read Connected and current, business source, and both sync directions; expand Platform diagnostics only for escalation.	No IDs, payloads, tokens, secrets, or raw connector errors are exposed.

Delivery wording

A durable queue/history entry proves that Conference Ops accepted and processed the workflow. Actual mailbox receipt still depends on the configured sender, Cloudflare Email, recipient system, and controlled receipt check.

08 / AIRTABLE FOR ORGANIZERS

Know what you may edit and when to stop

Conference Ops 0.3 supports Airtable as the source of truth for 38 registered conference business entity types, while D1 remains the transactional workflow mirror. The new entity set is not declared live by this guide: an operator must deploy, migrate, fully reconcile, confirm health, and prove a reversed allowlisted round trip first. The panel exposes no base IDs, table IDs, tokens, webhook secrets, or record payloads.

Do	Do not
After the operator's post-deploy checks, confirm the status panel says the connection is healthy and the intended authority is active.	Do not assume the base or expanded registry is live because tables exist.
Edit only documented descriptive fields and wait for the app to reflect the change.	Do not edit External Key, Entity Type, hashes, canonical structure, permissions, decisions, review finality, completion, publication, or deletion.
Use Conference Ops for lifecycle work; ask the operator for a supported Workflow Command when documented.	Do not add ad hoc command types, duplicate idempotency keys, delete canonical rows, or clear conflicts blindly.
Report a conflict with event, entity/key label, visible reason, approximate time, and intended value.	Do not include PATs, webhook secrets, record payloads containing private data, or screenshots of provisioning artifacts.

Stop

If the panel reports pending, dead, conflict, degraded, blocked, syncing, or unhealthy state, pause spreadsheet edits and contact the operator. Never ask an organizer to force authority or edit connection bookkeeping.

09 / TROUBLESHOOTING

What to check before filing feedback

Symptom	Check first	Then report
Wrong workspace/role	Confirm eventId, role selector, verified account, invitation/claim email, and that you did not reuse another person's session.	Event slug, role, URL, and approximate time.
No review	Confirm explicit track mapping, reviewer acceptance, proposal track, and self-review exclusion.	Proposal label and expected track coverage, without private review content.
Cannot edit proposal	Confirm it is non-final, before pinned form close, and not accepted/rejected/session-backed.	Visible status, form label/version notice, and expected edit path.
Cannot publish	Open readiness; resolve content approval, unscheduled sessions, conflicts, incomplete required speaker work, or unpublished resources as applicable.	Exact readiness item and linked page.
Email/calendar absent	Check approved recipient preview, configured sender, durable history status, and spam/quarantine only in the test mailbox.	Message kind, recipient you control, status, and approximate time - never token links.
Airtable does not update	Pause edits; check authority/health, pending/dead/conflicts, webhook state, and whether the field is allowlisted.	Non-secret status labels, entity/key label, expected descriptive value, and time.
File fails	Check role/task access, file extension/MIME, size, and non-empty content.	Task label, extension, approximate size, and visible error - never the sensitive file itself.

Before sending a screenshot

- Remove passwords, names/emails not needed for the report, reset/invitation links, private file contents, Airtable IDs/tokens/secrets, and provisioning artifacts.
- Include browser, viewport, URL path, event slug, persona, expected result, actual result, and whether reload changed it.

Organizer evaluation checklist

- Own verified organizer account; launch an isolated event from a blueprint/validated structure; apply logo and accent.
- Preview all four personas and complete/reset the guided tour without switching identity or deleting event data.
- Multiple/single CFP behavior, conditional field, track question, preview, publish, and form-specific link.
- Dated round, reviewer pool/cap, typed criteria, blind option, recusal, progress, reminder, results/CSV, AI triage override, and Approve/Maybe/Deny.
- Applicant draft, multi-track submission, organizer change request or self edit, resubmit, and final lock.
- Final acceptance creates session, speaker access, task plan, audit, and message intent.
- Private hotel/flight, organizer-only profile publication, content revisions/restore/approval, files/ZIP, comments, and resource reading.
- List/Day/Week/Conflicts, draft/apply/undo schedule, collision, reasoned override or reschedule, content approval, and publish.
- Signed-out Sessions, Speakers, Agenda, Itinerary, and Gallery plus feeds/embed show approved public data only.
- Resolved recipient preview, organizer-only [TEST] send, controlled email/calendar receipt/history, and safe exports.
- Control Room Now/Next/Proof and timeline, supervised copilot preview, client-readable Airtable proof, and speaker next action.
- After deployment: all 38 Airtable entity types reconciled, Healthy/intended authority, reversed allowlisted round trip, and no direct protected-state edits.

Useful
verdict

For each line, record Pass, Gap, Blocked by setup, or Not needed. Attach a short reason and the page/role involved. This gives the product team actionable acceptance evidence without exposing private content.

Pilot: <https://conference-ops-pilot-app.techfren.workers.dev>

Source commit: pilot-wow candidate based on e7757a7; record final commit after CI

Conference Ops 0.3.0 / organizer trial guide / August 9, 2026